Waipapa Taumata Rau
University of Auckland

Part IV Project #123
Department of Electrical, Computer, and Software Engineering

AI-Based Virtual Parliament

Does more Hansard grounding improve AI debate?

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We built a virtual New Zealand Parliament to study how language models debate. We tested whether more Hansard excerpts, drawn from real parliamentary speeches, improve debate quality.

1 One platform, three interfaces

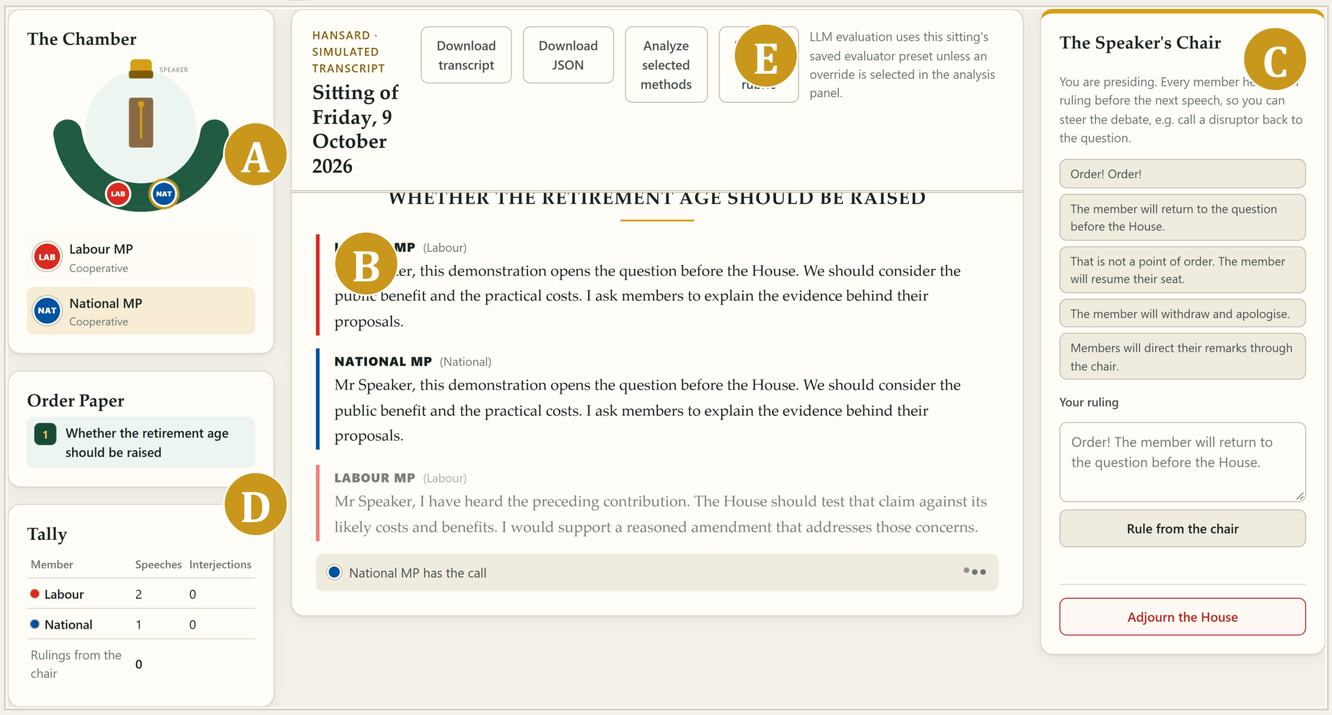


Fig. 1 Updated browser in deterministic demo mode. Browser, guided CLI and commands share one backend.

A The Chamber
Members light up as they speak.
Party roles appear in the chamber.

B Live Hansard
Speeches stream into Hansard.
Saved sittings reopen after restart.

C The Speaker's Chair
Your rulings reach every member before the next scheduled speech.

D Order Paper and Tally
Topics progress through the agenda.
Speeches and interjections count live.

E Exports and evaluation
Download JSON or text. Run local analysis or the separate LLM rubric.

2 Private agents, reproducible debates

Real Hansard	Private setup	Five AI MPs	Debate engine	Saved evidence
500 reviewed excerpts 100 per party [1]	Own persona, excerpts and optional tactic	Own setup + public debate evidence	Turns, topics, reply cues and rulings	Public transcript + separate evaluations

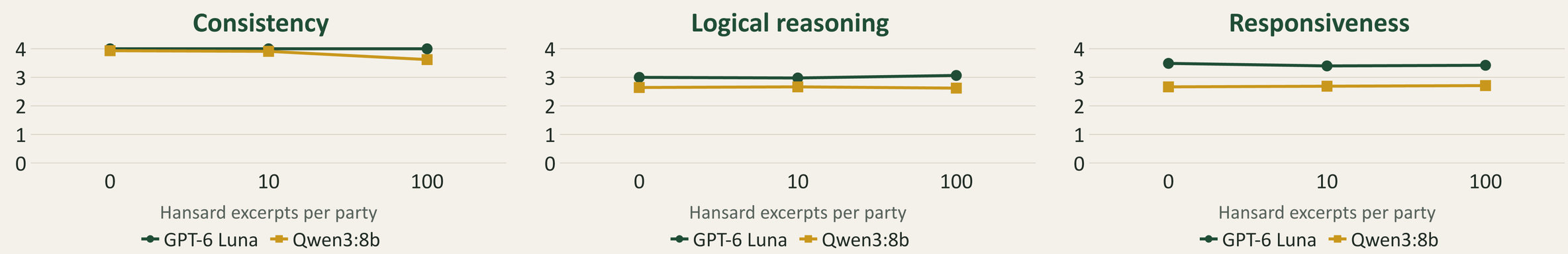
Independent debate and judge models, including Ollama. Captured prompts and settings preserve each run.

Five separate rubric metrics plus local sentiment and stance. Private setup stays out of public exports.

3 More grounding gave no consistent gain

2 models × 3 topics × 3 grounding levels × 3 repetitions = 54 debates, 1,350 speeches [2]

Five parties, five rounds. Retirement age, nuclear power and the four-day workweek. No adversarial tactics or interruptions.



Qwen consistency: 3.93 at 0 excerpts, 3.62 at 100 (-0.31 points). Other changes were small or mixed.

Relevance endpoints were unchanged (Luna 4.00, Qwen 3.98). Disruptive rhetoric averaged 0.00-0.04.

Nine debates per model/level, 45 party scores per metric. Common GPT-6 Luna judge. Higher rhetoric means more disruption.

Exploratory automated scores without human validation. These baseline runs do not test adversarial robustness.

4 Outcomes and next steps

Outcome
A reproducible debate platform. Extra Hansard showed no consistent gain in rubric scores.

Next work
Test adversarial tactics. Add human review, more topics and more repetitions.

Contributions
Albert Sun: frontend and live chamber.
Kieran Joe: architecture and MP agents.

References
[1] Rauh & Schwalbach (2020). ParlSpeech V2.
[2] Project 123 debate evaluation study, October 2026.

Acknowledgements
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Members are AI archetypes, not real MPs.

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